

Wenni Yang

Citizenship: Chinese (U.S. permanent residency pending)

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Research Fields

Primary fields: Labor Economics, Health Economics **Secondary fields:** Economics of Education, Economic History

Education

Ph.D. in Economics, University of California, Davis	2021–Winter 2027 (<i>expected</i>)
M.A. in Economics, Fudan University, Shanghai	2021
Exchange Student in Economics, Erasmus University Rotterdam	2019
B.A. in Economics (Insurance Specialization), East China Normal University, Shanghai	2018

Publications

“Congestion on the Information Superhighway: Does Economics Have a Working Papers Problem?” with Lester R. Lusher and Scott E. Carrell. *Journal of Public Economics*, Volume 225, 2023. [[published link](#)] [[ungated](#)] [[NBER WP29153](#)]

Working Papers

Job Market Paper—“Doctors With(out) Borders: Effects of Easing Occupational Licensing for Foreign-trained Physicians”

Newly digitized state licensure records · AMA physician directories, individuals linked across years · County-level AHA hospital and NCHS mortality data · Staggered DiD across state reform dates

“The Effects of Marriage Bar: Evidence from US Teachers in 1900–1940,” with Rebecca Brough

Hand-collected marriage bar adoption and repeal, U.S. city school boards · Newspapers and journals · 1880–1940 Census · Staggered DiD across city-level adoption timing

“Cash for Class: The Effect of Paying Students for Full-Time Community College Enrollment,” with Paco Martorell, Scott E. Carrell, Elizabeth Friedmann, and Alice Li

Student-level linkage across large administrative datasets · Regression discontinuity at an income eligibility threshold

Policy Reports

“Effects of Financial Aid Expansion for Community College Adult Learners,” with Oded Gurantz, Michal Kurlaender, Elizabeth Friedmann, and Paco Martorell. *Revise and Resubmit*.

Works in Progress

“Competition Without Entry: Evidence from California’s 1961 DO–MD Merger”

“Hospital Desegregation and the Black Medical Profession,” with Mark Anderson

“Addressing OCR Failures in Economic History: An Agentic AI Approach,” with Joshua Barnett

“Long-run Health Impact of Accessing Licensed Physicians”

Fellowships and Awards

Russell Sage Foundation Dissertation Fellowship	2026
Dean’s Summer Graduate Support Award	2026
ASHEcon Diversity Scholarship	2026
UC President’s Lindau Nobel Laureate Meeting Fellowship	2025
Research Grant (*4), UC Davis Economics Department	2023–2026

External Conference Presentations

2026: Becker Friedman Institute Health Economics Initiative Conference, ASHEcon, ASSA
2025: Economic History Association Meeting, Lindau Nobel Laureate Meeting in Economics Science

Teaching

University of California, Davis

Project Manager, Undergraduate Research Fellow Program (15+ students) 2024, 2025
Teaching Assistant, Econ 001A: Introductory Microeconomics 2021, 2022, 2025

Fudan University

Teaching Assistant, Quantitative Economics 2021
Teaching Assistant, Industrial Organization 2020
Teaching Assistant, Health Economics and Policy 2019

Employment

Research Assistant for Professors Scott Carrell and Paco Martorell, UC Davis 2022–present
Research Assistant for Professor Sharon Xuejing Zuo, Fudan University 2021
Mergers & Acquisitions Intern, Fosun International, Shanghai Dec. 2020–May 2021
Research Assistant for Professor Laura Hering, Erasmus University of Rotterdam 2020

Service and Leadership

Referee: *Economic Inquiry* 2026
Discussant (×2): Global Migration Center Student Seminar, UC Davis 2025
Co-organizer: Applied Micro Student Talk, UC Davis 2023–2025
Head Organizer: Gender Economics Reading Group (15+ students), UC Davis 2021–2022

Other Skills

Software: Stata, R, Python, SQL, MATLAB, LaTeX
Data: Large-scale administrative data; historical data digitization (OCR / LLM-assisted extraction) of AMA physician directories and state licensure records; record linkage and fuzzy matching
Language: Chinese (Native), English (Fluent)

References

Santiago Pérez Associate Professor of Economics University of California, Davis seperez@ucdavis.edu (+1) 650-739-3478	Marianne P. Bitler Professor and Chair of Economics University of California, Davis bitler@ucdavis.edu (+1) 415-305-5644	Giovanni Peri Professor of Economics University of California, Davis gperi@ucdavis.edu (+1) 510-734-3774
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